

A Brief History of Thornquist House

Thornquist House stands on a low hill above the river, and for almost two centuries it has served as a home, a school and a library. This short history gathers what is known about the building and the people who kept it.

The account is divided into five parts. It begins with the founding of the house, follows the story of its lost archive, and ends with a few words about what remains today.

The Founding

The house was founded by Alaric Thornquist, a cartographer who bought the hill in the spring of 1847. According to the deed, the purchase was completed on 14 March 1847 and the first stones were laid before the summer.

Thornquist wanted a quiet place to draw his maps. He built a workroom with tall north windows, a cellar for the finished charts and a long table that is still in use.

His neighbours described him as careful, patient and fond of lists. He wrote the name of every visitor in a small green notebook.

The keepers of the house followed a short set of rules, which are still posted in the hall.

1. Wash your hands before opening a book.
2. Return every map to its own drawer.
3. Write your name in the green notebook.

Year	Keeper	Event
1847	Alaric Thornquist	House founded
1861	Mira Thornquist	School opened in the east wing
1893	Edda Lindqvist	Library catalogue completed
1952	Pavel Okonkwo	Roof repaired after the storm

The Lost Archive

In the autumn of 1893 the keeper Edda Lindqvist recorded that one box of papers had been moved from the cellar. The box was labelled with the identifier MS-4471 and contained letters, receipts and a half-finished map of the coast.

No later catalogue mentions MS-4471 again. Some believe the papers were sold to pay for the new roof; others say they were hidden behind a panel in the north wall, where the air stays dry.

A search in 1952 found only an empty shelf and a faded label.

Conclusion

Today Thornquist House is open to visitors on three afternoons a week. The workroom, the long table and the green notebooks can all be seen, though the lost archive has never been found.

The history of the house shows how a private project can become a public memory. It also shows how much depends on the people who take the trouble to write things down.